

English 101 – Writing Rubric

English proficiency test, writing section. 150 to 200 words.

TOTAL	CRITERIA	TASK TYPES	PREPARED FOR
20 points	5	Opinion essay, formal letter or email	Hamdan Bin Mohammed Smart University

1 Task Achievement

5 points

Does the response answer the prompt, stay on topic and meet the word count?

POINTS	DESCRIPTOR
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5	Fully addresses every part of the prompt. Position is clear throughout. Ideas are developed with relevant support. Within 150 to 200 words.
3–4	Addresses the prompt, but one part is thin or underdeveloped. Position is mostly clear. Some support is general rather than specific.
1–2	Addresses the prompt only partly, or drifts off topic. Position is unclear or inconsistent. Noticeably under or over the word count.
0	Does not address the prompt, or is too short to assess.

2 Organisation and Coherence

4 points

Is the text logically built up, and does it flow?

POINTS	DESCRIPTOR
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4	Clear introduction, body and conclusion. Logical progression. Linking words used accurately and not overused.
3	Recognisable structure. Progression is mostly logical with one or two abrupt shifts. Linking words present but repetitive.
1–2	Little structure. Ideas are listed rather than developed. Linking words are missing or used wrongly.
0	No discernible organisation.

3 Grammar and Accuracy

5 points

Range and correctness of sentence structures.

POINTS	DESCRIPTOR
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5	Wide range of structures. Errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
3–4	Mix of simple and complex structures. Errors occur but meaning stays clear.
1–2	Mainly simple structures. Frequent errors that sometimes obscure meaning.
0	Errors are so frequent that meaning is lost.

4 Vocabulary and Register

4 points

Word choice, precision and tone.

POINTS	DESCRIPTOR
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4	Precise and varied vocabulary. Register fits the task, formal for a letter and neutral for an essay.
3	Adequate vocabulary with some repetition. Register is mostly appropriate.
1–2	Limited and repetitive vocabulary. Word choice errors. Register is inconsistent or inappropriate.
0	Vocabulary is too limited to convey the message.

5 Spelling and Punctuation

2 points

Surface accuracy.

POINTS	DESCRIPTOR
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2	Few errors, none that distract the reader.
1	Regular errors but the text remains readable.
0	Errors throughout, reading is difficult.

Total score

/ 20 points

Converting to another scale. If the Moodle quiz question carries a different point value, divide the score by 20 and multiply by the point value of the question. A score of 15 out of 20 on a 10 point question becomes 7.5.